



We did major experimentation in developing and using virtual laboratory well before any other institution. In fact, it would not be an exaggeration to claim that the recently launched 'Virtual Laboratory' project under the National Mission Project in Education through ICT probably owes its origin at IIT Kharagpur.

Criteria of selection

Most of the time, technology is used in education just because it is available. What should really happen is the reverse. Teaching/learning situations which could benefit from the use of technology need to be identified. One needs to analyse exactly what the gap is and what kind of technology is likely to prove most effective.

Currently, two important classes of technology are used to supplement teaching-learning. These are video technology (video-based instruction, video conferencing and video as learning resource)

and computer technology (computer-aided instruction, computer-based training, Web-based learning (where the content is available over a network rather than on a standalone machine).

We can combine both the technologies and create e-learning using many sophisticated pedagogic models. IIT Kharagpur is engaged in several such experimentations. The technology tool to be used also depends on the facilities currently available/or likely to be available soon with the user community.

Bend towards innovation

IIT Kharagpur is probably at the forefront of the innovative use of technology to empower teaching.

We have three fully equipped video studios and over 200 video courses available as VOD on the campus.

We have a very large number (135×40-hours) of Web courses available on our Web server. In fact, IIT Kharagpur

contributed the lion's share of video courses for the Gyan Darshan channel, Eklavya channel and also the NPTEL programme.

We are the anchor institution in India in the national mission project 'Developing Suitable Pedagogical Method for Various Classes, Intellectual Calibers of Learners and Research in e-learning.' This extremely important project is expected to involve several hundred faculty members and experts from all across the country and is likely to provide the lead for a major change in higher technical education.

IIT Kharagpur, is planning to start three M.Tech programmes very soon using highly modern interactive videoconferencing facilities connecting 13 classrooms spread over our Kolkata and Bhubaneswar campuses to the main campus of IIT Kharagpur. We plan to use high-definition video and simultaneous both-way audio and video links for this purpose. ■

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69/2A, 2nd Floor, Najafgarh Road Industrial Area
(Near Moti Nagar Crossing) New Delhi-110015.

Phone: 011-64508649, 64508650, 25995324, Fax: 011-45013465,

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